



eCBHFA

Health in emergencies

Facilitator guide for empowering communities



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eCBHFA

Health in emergencies

Facilitator guide

The International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC) is the world's largest volunteer-based humanitarian network, reaching 150 million people each year through our 191 member National Societies. Together, we act before, during and after disasters and health emergencies to meet the needs and improve the lives of vulnerable people. We do so with impartiality as to nationality, race, gender, religious beliefs, class and political opinions.

Our strength lies in our volunteer network, our community-based expertise and our independence and neutrality. We work to improve humanitarian standards, as partners in development and in response to disasters. We persuade decision-makers to act at all times in the interests of vulnerable people. The result: we enable healthy and safe communities, reduce vulnerabilities, strengthen resilience and foster a culture of peace around the world.

The IFRC is proud to work with USAID to help National Societies better prepare communities, National Societies, governments, civil society and the private sector to prevent and reduce the number of deaths in the aftermath of disaster and during disease outbreaks.

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Foreword

Communities that are affected by emergencies, such as a natural or man-made disaster, a disease outbreak or conflict are immediately forced to cope with the emergency's impact. Though the Red Cross and Red Crescent Movement trains staff and volunteers to provide support to those that are in crisis-affected communities, no one can get to the emergency faster than volunteers who are themselves in the community/ies being impacted. Time and time again we have seen Red Cross and Red Crescent volunteers providing much-needed support to their communities immediately after a crisis, even while they try to support themselves and their family through the emergency. This is the power of you as a Red Cross and Red Crescent volunteer – with the right knowledge and skills you can help yourself, your family and your neighbours in need, before anyone else can get there.

In the days and weeks after a crisis, we need people who understand the community. No two communities, or even families, are the same, and so the community understanding and ability to adapt our work is critical in this effort. To launch an effective response plan we need to know who might be most affected, where the biggest risks are, how people can be reached, and where to bring help. You and your fellow Red Cross Red Crescent volunteers know this information better than anyone else. You are key to making sure your community gets the help that it needs in the areas it is needed. You are also instrumental in delivering assistance, as first aiders and as people who understand the health of your community. This guide helps you build on your existing skills to understand the additional risks that emergencies pose and how you might help to prevent or respond to them.

As your community begins to recover, and external support begins to leave, you will continue to be custodians of your community's health. You can help with ongoing efforts to improve the health of your community, re-establish your community health initiatives from before the crisis struck, and re-assess your community risks to develop new initiatives that will prevent or mitigate the impact of a future emergency situation.

This guide will equip you with the basics for eCBHFA volunteers on health in emergencies – how volunteers are the first responders in any and every crisis, their roles in the response and how to link other actors to those most in need in the community. The module also outlines how volunteers shift from programme cycle to disaster cycle and back as the crisis evolves and the unique role of CBHFA volunteers.

Using the guides and toolkit

Health in emergencies volunteer guide

This guide is designed for community volunteers. It helps volunteers understand their unique role as true first responders in the immediate aftermath of any crisis. The guide contains key information and discussion points to work with community members in understanding their role in programming and crisis response to ensure those who are most at risk are being served appropriately.

The volunteer guide is comprised of four topics which include knowledge, tools, talking points and activities for teaching in an interactive way.

Health in emergencies toolkit

The toolkit is designed to support both the volunteer guide and the facilitator guide with interactive tools, games and illustrative material. The toolkit can be adapted and modified to local contexts, taking advantage of both local expertise and knowledge and differences in Ministry of Health approaches. Materials have been specifically designed to be printed in black and white or full colour, and with low-resource environments in mind.

Health in emergencies facilitator guide

This guide is designed for staff or trainers to conduct a training of trainers (ToT) or preparation course for staff and volunteers.

The facilitator guide allows volunteers hands-on experience and practice with all the toolkit materials so that they will be able to teach the community about their role in health following a crisis.

Health in emergencies topics

Topic	Contents
1	Programme cycle and disaster cycle
2	Emergency teams
3	eCBHFA volunteers as vital link between community and emergency teams
4	Emergency teams

Topic 1

Programme cycle and disaster cycle

Overview

This topic outlines the stages of the programme cycle, where the focus is on development of prevention and preparedness activities, and the stages of the disaster cycle and describes the volunteer's role in each stage of both cycles. If an emergency occurs, the volunteer will learn how to shift from the development stages to the disaster stages as the need arises. eCBHFA volunteers play a critical role in health emergencies. The role of the volunteer at each stage of the programme cycle and the disaster cycle is explained. Volunteers prepare for an emergency or disaster conditions through the implementation of the Red Cross Red Crescent programme cycle. Here is where volunteers assess, plan, implement, monitor and evaluate programmes or projects in their communities that focus on prevention and preparedness. The disaster cycle then details the disaster management cycle stages of any disaster or outbreak.

Learning objectives

By the end of this topic, volunteers will be better able to:

1. Identify stages of the Red Cross Red Crescent programme cycle focusing on prevention and preparedness and the role of the eCBHFA volunteer at each stage
2. Identify stages of the Red Cross Red Crescent disaster cycle and the role of the eCBHFA volunteer at each stage
3. Explain how an eCBHFA volunteer shifts the focus of their work from programme needs to disaster needs appropriately
4. Teach the programme cycle and disaster cycle to their community

Tools

- ❑ Programme cycle poster
- ❑ Disaster cycle poster

Suggested outline of activities

Activity	Time
Introduction	20 min
Programme cycle	15 min
Reflection	10 min
Disaster cycle	15 min
Reflection	10 min
Role of eCBHFA in a disaster	45 min
Reflection	10 min
Red Cross Red Crescent emergency tools	10 min
Reflection	10 min
Wrap-up	10 min
Total time	2 hrs, 35 min

Preparation

1. Write the learning objectives for the topic on chart paper and post at the front of the room.
2. Prepare copies of the topic and tools from the volunteer guide for each trainee.

Introduction

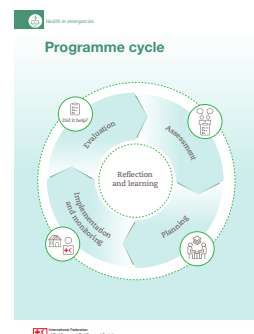
1. Welcome the volunteers to the topic. Tell them that this topic explores the eCBHFA programme cycle and the disaster cycle. Explain that the programme cycle is about prevention and preparedness while the disaster cycle outlines the stages of a disaster or an emergency. Volunteers will learn about the important roles they play before, during and after a disaster or an emergency.

2. Introduce the topic objectives and explain the agenda and activities that they will do to meet those objectives.
3. Distribute the topic **Programme cycle and disaster cycle** from the volunteer guide.
 - Explain that volunteers will be taught how to use two tools during the session and that they will be expected to practise using these tools and demonstrate their skill in delivering the content.
 - Allow approximately two minutes for the volunteers to become familiar with the topic materials.
4. Instruct volunteers to form groups of three or four. In their groups, volunteers should read the topic **Programme cycle and disaster cycle** to themselves or as a group, whichever way they feel more comfortable.
 - After the group has completed reading, they should discuss the Reflection questions from the topic and be prepared for one of them to share their responses with the whole group.
 - Allow approximately 15 minutes for reading and discussion.
5. After 15 minutes, hold a whole group session and ask for responses from each small group. Put right any misinformation and ask for any questions.

Programme cycle

Programme cycle poster

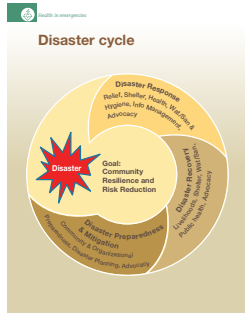
1. Hand out the Programme cycle poster and give volunteers a couple of minutes to review the information.
2. Using the poster, explain each stage in the programme cycle. Offer examples for each stage. Ask volunteers if they understand all the stages in the poster. Answer their questions, clarify any misconceptions and correct misunderstandings.
3. Ask volunteers to find a partner and to practise explaining the four stages of the programme cycle. Partners should take turns practising. Give them five to seven minutes to practise.
4. Bring volunteers back to the whole group. Ask one volunteer to present to the whole group.



Programme cycle practice questions

1. How do you feel about teaching the four stages in the programme cycle to your community? Do you feel comfortable explaining the programme cycle poster?
2. Which elements or concepts do you think will be difficult for you to explain within your community?

Disaster cycle



Disaster cycle poster

1. Hand out the Disaster cycle poster.
2. Using the poster, explain each stage in the disaster cycle.
3. Ask volunteers if they understand all the stages in the poster. Answer questions, clarify any misconceptions and correct misunderstandings.
4. Ask volunteers to get into groups of three or four and takes turns explaining the four stages of the disaster cycle. Give them five to seven minutes to practise.
5. Bring volunteers back to whole group. In plenary, discuss:
 - How do you feel about teaching the four stages in the disaster cycle to your community? Do you feel comfortable explaining the disaster cycle poster?
 - Which stages have you personally assisted in within your community?

Role of eCBHFA in the disaster cycle

1. Explain that eCBHFA volunteers have a role to play in each stage of a disaster.
2. Divide the participants into four groups – preparedness and mitigation, disaster or outbreak, response and recovery. Give a piece of flipchart paper, like the examples below cut into three columns, to each group.

At the front of the room on a flipchart sheet, show a chart that the mitigation team will use:



3. Explain that for their assigned phase, each group should brainstorm the role of the eCBHFA volunteer for the crisis event of conflict. They may talk with the members of other groups to ensure alignment of activities. Give groups ten minutes to brainstorm their responses.

4. When they finish, instruct each group to bring the completed column to a wall where you will tape the four sheets in a cycle pattern.



5. Ask one member of each group to present their proposed activities.
6. After all four groups have presented in order, ask the full group:
 - Do the activities align? If not, explain why it is important to stay informed with other responders.
 - Are the listed activities in the right phases?
 - What is missing?
7. Continue this activity with the second crisis column. If a group wishes to switch their phase with another group, they may negotiate to do so. When they have their phase, each group should discuss the activities that the eCB-HFA should do in that phase for the crisis of flooding.
8. When they finish, instruct each group to bring the completed column to a wall where you will tape the four sheets in a cycle pattern next to the Conflict disaster cycle.
9. Ask one member of each group to present their proposed activities.
10. After all four groups have presented in order, ask the full group:
 - Do the activities align? If not, explain why it is important to stay informed with other responders.
 - Are the listed activities in the right phases?
 - What is missing?

Preparedness
and mitigation

FLOODING

*Preparedness
and mitigation*

MEASLES

11. Finish this activity with the third crisis column. If a group wishes to switch their phase with another group, they may negotiate to do so. When they have their phase, each group should discuss the activities that the eCBHFA should do in that phase for the crisis of a measles outbreak.
12. When they finish, instruct each group to bring the completed column to a wall where you will tape the four sheets in a cycle pattern next to the Conflict and Flooding disaster cycles.
13. Ask one member of each group to present their proposed activities.
14. After all four groups have presented in order, ask the full group:
 - Do the activities align? If not, explain why it is important to stay informed with other responders.
 - Are the listed activities in the right phases?
 - What is missing?
 - What do we know about the impact of eCBHFA volunteers before, during and after a crisis?
 - Have you ever responded to a disaster in your community? What did you do? If you are eCBHFA trained has it been useful in being able to respond effectively?

Wrap-up

1. Review the learning objectives on the flipchart and ask the volunteers if they feel they have achieved each.
2. Ask volunteers about any questions or concerns..

Topic 2

Cycle of health needs post-emergency

Overview

This topic discusses the cycle of health needs post-emergency and explains the role of the eCBHFA volunteer during this critical time. Red Cross Red Crescent and eCBHFA volunteers have a vital role to play in the aftermath of an emergency. eCBHFA volunteers are critical as they have first-hand knowledge about their community and its health, including knowledge of past assessments and disease prevention measures.

Based on experiences from previous emergencies, the cycle of health needs post-emergency can be somewhat forecast and, therefore, planned so as to reduce the number of people needing assistance or even save lives.

Learning objectives

By the end of this session, volunteers will be better able to:

1. Understand the ongoing impacts of a crisis situation, such as a disaster or disease outbreak, on health
2. Prepare for potential health impacts following a crisis
3. Teach about the cycle of health needs post-emergency

Tools

- ❑ Needs for healthy living poster
- ❑ Emergency health action game

Suggested outline of activities

Activity	Time
Introduction	30 min
Needs for healthy living	10 min
Reflection	10 min
Red Cross Red Crescent eCBHFA volunteer role during and after a crisis event	30 min
Reflection	10 min
The immediate aftermath	40 min
Putting it into action	55 min
Emergency health action game	30 min
Wrap-up	10 min
Total time	3 hrs, 45 min

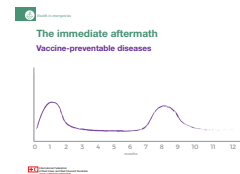
Preparation

1. Write the learning objectives for the topic on chart paper and post at the front of the room.
2. Prepare copies of the topic and tools from the volunteer guide for each trainee.
3. Prepare flipcharts for the Before, During and After activities of a crisis event.
4. Write disaster scenario on chart paper for later posting.

Introduction

1. Welcome the volunteers to the topic. Explain that in order to be effective when working on a health emergency team, eCBHFA volunteers need to understand who might be working on the team with them, what are the expectations of trained eCBHFA volunteers on the team, and the importance of coordination and communication between team members and other organizations.

2. Introduce the topic objectives and explain the agenda and activities that they will do to meet those objectives.
3. Distribute the topic **Cycle of health needs post-emergency** from the volunteer guide. Allow approximately two minutes for the volunteers to become familiar with the topic materials.
4. Instruct volunteers to form groups of three or four. (If it is a mixed gender class, try to make sure there are both men and women in each group.) In their groups, volunteers should read the topic **Cycle of health needs post-disaster** to themselves or as a group, whichever way they feel more comfortable.
 - After the group has completed reading, they should discuss the Reflection questions from the topic and be prepared for one of them to share their responses with the whole group.
 - Allow approximately 25 minutes for reading and discussion.
5. After 25 minutes, hold a whole group session and discuss in plenary the overall topic content.



Needs for healthy living

Needs for healthy living poster

1. Distribute Needs for healthy living poster to volunteers.
2. Review the poster and content in the volunteer guide explaining the six needs and the requirement to have all basic needs met for people to thrive. Provide examples throughout that show what happens when a need is not met. Call out the needs in turn and ask volunteers to provide some examples of what could happen if that need is not met.
3. Ask volunteers to get into groups of three or four and take turns practising how to explain the poster to people in the community. Give groups five minutes to practise. Ask for one volunteer to present what they practised to the whole group.



Needs for healthy living reflection questions

1. Do you feel comfortable explaining the needs for healthy living poster and providing examples of what happens when needs are not met?
2. Explain why understanding of the needs for healthy living is important for eCBHFA volunteers.

Red Cross Red Crescent eCBHFA volunteer role during and after a crisis event

1. Review the role of Red Cross Red Crescent and eCBHFA volunteers in the immediate aftermath of disaster. Emphasize the role volunteers play in providing basic first aid and psychological first aid, as well as the distribution of food, tarpaulins, jerry cans for water, etc. Ask volunteers what other support they may be called on to provide?

2. On a piece of flipchart paper, write the word VULNERABLE in the centre in large letters. Define vulnerability and ensure all are comfortable with the definition.
3. Ask the group to call out types of community members who might be considered vulnerable such as “pregnant women” or “nomadic tribes”, etc. Write these responses around the word VULNERABLE on the flipchart paper.
4. Place the participants in groups of three people each. Give each group a piece of flip chart paper with three columns on the sheet.

The image shows a flipchart template with a light gray background and a torn-edge effect. At the top, it says "Vulnerable group:" followed by a horizontal line. Below this, there are three vertical columns. The first column is labeled "Before", the second "During", and the third "After". The columns are separated by thin vertical lines.

5. Assign one of the identified vulnerable groups to each group. Tell the groups to discuss and define actions that eCBHFA volunteers should do to assess the needs of the vulnerable group before, during and after a crisis event. Ask them to think about health risks for which their vulnerable group may need their support and what the volunteer can do to provide support at all stages. Give them seven minutes to discuss.
6. After seven minutes, ask them to post their flipcharts at the front of the room and present their actions.

Reflection

1. What are the vulnerable groups we identified? What makes a group vulnerable? Are these groups more vulnerable at certain times? Explain.
2. What types of actions did we identify for all of the vulnerable groups pre-crisis?
3. What types of actions did we identify for all of the vulnerable groups during a crisis?
4. What types of actions did we identify for all of the vulnerable groups after a crisis?
5. How can eCBHFA volunteers use this information to keep their communities well-prepared at all times?

The immediate aftermath

1. Remind volunteers that they play an important role during and immediately after the crisis event. Before the event, eCBHFA volunteers are well placed to work with and support communities to plan ahead for the health needs of their community in the months following a crisis event.
2. Ask volunteers to refer to their volunteer manual. Hold up the trauma/first aid graphic from the toolkit. Explain the graph and what the graph says about how eCBHFA volunteers can prepare for and support their community post-crisis.
3. From the volunteer guide and referring to the graphs, go through the other health issues that are anticipated after a large crisis event. Ask the group to share their responses to the Reflection questions to ensure understanding of each health issue:
 - Why are volunteers advised to keep their first aid skills current?
 - Why is psychological first aid so important immediately after a crisis?
 - Why do you think psychological first aid is often needed several months after the initial crisis has occurred?
 - How can volunteers support each other with psychosocial support?
 - How are PFA and PSS linked?
 - Why are waterborne diseases such a high risk immediately after many crisis events?
 - In looking at the graph of needs for maternal and newborn risks, the lines do not match. Why is there a greater risk for mothers at some times and at different times for newborns?
 - How can a volunteer support new mothers and their babies in a crisis?
 - How can eCBHFA volunteers help to prevent vaccine-preventable diseases in their community?
 - What are the four NCDs?
 - How can volunteers help people with NCDs get access to the medicine and support they need after a crisis?
 - What is a vector?
 - How can eCBHFA volunteers help their communities to prevent vector-borne diseases?
 - What are some of the eCBHFA volunteers' greatest responsibilities before a crisis? During a crisis? After the crisis has passed?
4. Ask for questions and provide clarification after the graphs are presented.

Putting it into action

1. Ask volunteers to get into groups of three or four. Provide chart paper and markers. Post the written scenario on a wall. Read the scenario below out loud.

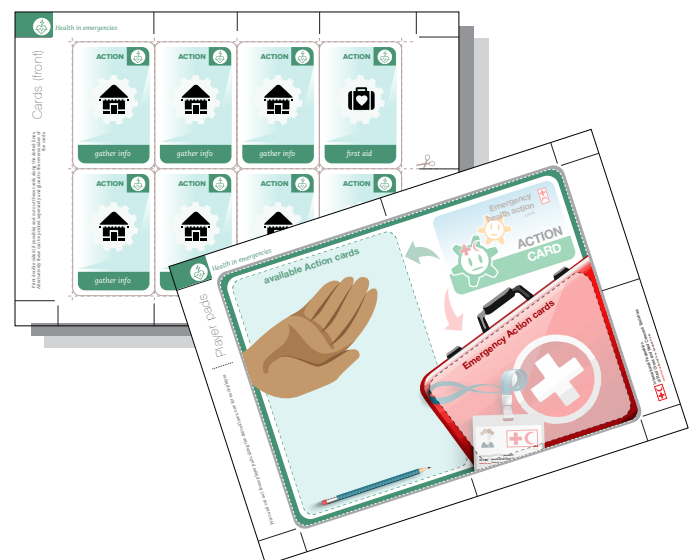
A tsunami has hit the coastline with 10,000 families losing their homes. More than 500 people lost their lives and many are still missing. It continues to rain every day since the tsunami. There are three camp areas where survivors are now living. You are

working in one of the camps where most of your community members are living. It is week one post-disaster. The date is (give today's date). Your team has been asked to develop a calendar for the next six months and plan for health activities in anticipation of continued health needs in your community.

2. Direct groups to develop a plan of health activities to prepare and respond to their community's evolving health needs for the next six months. Use today's date as a starting point and consider the suggested timing of different health risks from the graphs in the toolkit. Give the groups up to 30 minutes to discuss and develop their plan.
3. In whole group session, ask several groups to share their plans. Respond to questions and clarify if necessary.

Emergency health action game

1. Distribute the emergency health action game and go over the instructions. Ask volunteers to get into groups of four or five and to start playing. Give groups about 30 minutes to complete the game. While they are playing, visit each group to ensure that they understand what they are supposed to do.
2. When they have finished, congratulate any winners and commiserate with any losers. Tell them that as they become more familiar with action in an emergency, they will become more adept players.



Wrap-up

1. Review the learning objectives on the flipchart and ask the volunteers if they feel they have achieved each one. Ask them if they feel that playing the emergency health action game with community members would help to explain what eCBHFA volunteers do in an emergency and why they do it.
2. Ask volunteers about any lingering questions or concerns. your body to fight off infection.

Topic 3

eCBHFA volunteers as vital link between the community and emergency teams

Overview

eCBHFA volunteers learn their critical role in improving the response by linking immediate community needs with local and Red Cross Red Crescent emergency response teams.

eCBHFA trained volunteers have much to contribute when working with emergency health teams after an emergency. Their knowledge of the community, past prevention activities, location of vulnerable people and ability to deliver health messaging is invaluable to the team and may be critical to its success.

Communities with eCBHFA trained volunteers in place pre-emergency should emerge from the crisis stronger and better equipped to address future crises as community members continually address health needs with their community health volunteers.

Learning objectives

By the end of this session, volunteers should be able to:

1. Explain the impact eCBHFA volunteers can have in an emergency response.
2. Explain the role of eCBHFA volunteers as link with emergency response teams.
3. Teach about the volunteer role in linking the community and emergency teams post-disaster.

Tools

- ❑ eCBHFA in action poster

Suggested outline of activities

Activity	Time
Introduction	20 min
eCBHFA volunteers' role when working with emergency health teams	20 min
Reflection	10 min
Active eCBHFA programming in the affected communities	40 min
Reflection	10 min
Wrap-up	10 min
Total time	1 hrs, 50 min

Preparation

1. Write the learning objectives for the topic on chart paper and post at the front of the room.
2. Prepare copies of the topic and tools from the volunteer guide for each trainee.
3. Pre-prepare several flipcharts with the following content. You will need to leave space to write the actions that can be taken in each area. :
 - first aid
 - psychological support services (PSS) and protection
 - road safety
 - malaria and dengue prevention
 - nutrition
 - immunizations
 - assessments
 - disease prevention
 - water, sanitation and hygiene promotion
 - Maternal and Newborn Child Health (MNCH)
 - noncommunicable diseases
 - tuberculosis
 - HIV and sexually transmitted diseases
 - diarrhoea and dehydration
 - addressing stigma and discrimination.

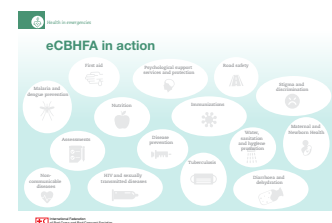
Introduction

1. Welcome the volunteers to the topic. Remind them that they play a critical role in improving response post-emergency by linking the community needs with local and Red Cross Red Crescent emergency response teams.
2. Introduce the topic objectives and explain the agenda and activities that they will do to meet those objectives.
3. Distribute the topic **eCBHFA volunteers as vital link between the community and emergency teams** from the volunteer guide. Allow approximately two minutes for the volunteers to become familiar with the topic materials.
4. Instruct volunteers to form groups of three or four. In their groups, volunteers should read the topic **eCBHFA volunteers as vital link between the community and emergency teams** to themselves or as a group, whichever way they feel more comfortable.
 - After the group has completed reading, they should discuss the Reflection questions from the topic and be prepared for one of them to share their responses with the larger group during a whole group session.
 - Allow approximately 15 minutes for reading and discussion.
5. After 15 minutes, hold a whole group session and ask for a representative from each group to share their discussion. Put right any misinformation and ask for general questions.

eCBHFA volunteers' role when working with emergency health teams

❏ eCBHFA in action poster

1. Remind volunteers of the essential role they play during post-emergency response including their ability to assess needs and report same, their relationships within the community, local knowledge and respect of culture and practices, as well as the existing link with the National Society branch. Additionally, volunteers address the ongoing health needs within their communities.
2. Show the eCBHFA in action poster from the toolkit. Ask volunteers to brainstorm what knowledge and skills they currently possess from their eCBHFA work that might benefit their communities before, during and after a response for each of the areas within the bubbles. Start with first aid, and move on to each of the areas in turn. If you feel they miss any knowledge and skills that eCBHFA teaches them, give them prompts.
3. As volunteers call out, write responses to each area on the pre-prepared flipcharts. Once all areas have been visited, post the flipcharts at the front of the room.



Reflection

1. During an emergency response, what advantage does an eCBHFA volunteer offer when working with emergency health teams?
2. When should you identify yourself as an eCBHFA volunteer to an emergency health team?

Active eCBHFA programming in the affected community

1. Describe a large disaster event that has happened in your community. You might wish to use something that has actually happened in the past, or you could use one of the following examples:
 - Persistent and massive flooding has claimed thousands of homes and hundreds of lives. Cholera is rampant in the camps, also claiming lives. Many parts of the main hospital are under water. It is still raining.
 - An outbreak of dengue is spreading rapidly. Already more than 70,000 people have been affected by the disease. Of the deaths, more than 60 per cent are children under the age of 15.
2. Ask volunteers to get into small groups of four or five, and to discuss what they, as eCBHFA volunteers, could do to help the emergency response teams that have come to help. What is the role of the eCBHFA volunteer? How do they interact with the members of the emergency response teams? Give them 20 minutes to discuss, and ask for one of them to be prepared to report their findings to the main group.
3. At the end of 20 minutes, bring them back to the plenary session and ask each of the groups to report.
4. Go over what they can do and how they can be most helpful to the emergency response teams. Remind them that they help emergency response teams to respond to the immediate health needs of the community, they help to identify critical needs, such as supplies and equipment and they put the teams in contact with particularly vulnerable people in the community. Volunteers may not be able to carry out their normal activities, but will focus on the broader emergency response team. They may also be asked to work in a different area, i.e. not their home community, and with other organizations, such as UNICEF.

eCBHFA volunteers' role when working with emergency health teams reflection questions

1. Do you feel comfortable explaining the eCBHFA volunteer role when working with emergency health teams to members of your home community?
2. Are there any areas where you feel you may have some difficulty?

Wrap-up

1. Review the learning objectives on the flipchart and ask volunteers if they feel they have achieved each one.
2. Ask volunteers about any lingering questions or concerns.

Topic 4

Emergency teams

Overview

This topic outlines the importance of communication, cooperation and team-work during a health emergency. The role of the eCBHFA volunteer is discussed when working with national and international colleagues as well as working alongside other emergency teams.

Learning objectives

By the end of this session, volunteers should be able to:

1. Identify initial priorities for volunteers according to the emergency
2. Identify the strengths and focus of the National Society in a health response
3. Gain an understanding of what the government and other organizations do in an emergency
4. Teach about what the volunteers' health role is in the community during an emergency

Tools

- Emergency response mechanism poster

Suggested outline of activities

Depending on the number of participants and amount of discussion, this topic will take approximately one hour, 50 minutes to complete.

Activity	Time
Introduction	30 min
Roles of Red Cross Red Crescent health teams	15 min
Reflection	10 min
Elements to be aware of when considering response	15 min
Reflection	10 min
Local emergency teams	10 min
Reflection	10 min
Wrap-up	10 min
Total time	1 hrs, 50 min

Preparation

1. Write the learning objectives for the topic on chart paper and post at the front of the room.
2. Prepare copies of the topic from the volunteer guide for each trainee.
3. Write group work scenarios on chart paper.

Topic summary

The National Red Cross Red Crescent Society is often well placed because of its existing programme work to provide prompt and essential response straight after an emergency. Staff and volunteers are often already well known and respected at the community level. Frequently, it happens that the National Society is the first responder during an emergency providing lifesaving assistance, shelter, water, food and basic healthcare. In addition, the initial information that they can provide to others who are drafted in to give assistance becomes vital to any further assessment planning.

Communication and coordination are vital elements of any team responding in an emergency. Communication and coordination are key elements for the eCBHfA team as well as for the National Society. But it is vital that the National Society and its volunteers form part of the overall response effort, which may include other national and international actors, and this is where communication and coordination, if effective, can ensure the most efficient response possible. Cooperation, good communication and a knowledge of how the overall response is organized can help eCBHfA volunteers to make a vital contribution to health during the response efforts.

In a major emergency many international teams arrive to provide additional assistance that is beyond the capacity of the National Society. These teams always work side by side, with the MoH being in charge of the overall response.

The overall coordination mechanism needs to ensure a clear understanding of what the National Red Cross Red Crescent Society and its staff and volunteers can do. Answers to the following questions help this understanding:

- What is needed in the immediate response? For example, is it necessary to supply first aid and distribute tarpaulins and jerry cans?
- Who can be mobilized? For example, where are the available volunteers and how many will be needed?
- What technical expertise is needed? For example, does a national team need to undertake search and rescue?
- What are strategies for looking after teams in the field? For example, what is the need for equipment and psychological support services (PSS).

Working as part of the overall response team is about identifying what strengths everyone brings, who has leadership skills, who can best ensure information is communicated and documented clearly, who best manages security of the team, how best to keep an eye on one another in the field and how best to work as an effective team.

Introduction

1. Welcome the volunteers to the topic. Explain that in order to be effective when working on a health emergency team, volunteers need to understand who might be working on the team with them, what are the expectations of trained eCBHfA volunteers on the team, and the importance of coordination and communication between team members and other organizations.
2. Introduce the topic objectives and explain the agenda and activities that they will do to meet those objectives.
3. Distribute the topic **Emergency teams** from the volunteer guide. Allow approximately two minutes for the volunteers to become familiar with the topic materials.
4. Instruct volunteers to form groups of three or four. (If it is a mixed gender class, try to make sure there are both men and women in each group.) In their groups, volunteers should read the topic **Emergency teams** to themselves or as a group, whichever way they feel more comfortable.
 - After the group has completed reading, they should discuss the Reflection questions from the topic and be prepared for one of them to share their responses with the larger group during a whole group session.

- Allow approximately 20 minutes for reading and discussion.
5. After 20 minutes, hold a whole group session and ask for a representative from each small group to present their discussion. Once they have all presented, correct any misinformation and ask for general questions.

Roles of Red Cross Red Crescent health teams

1. Remind volunteers that the Red Cross Red Crescent plays many roles during a health emergency. Ask volunteers to identify what roles they may be asked to play? Write responses on chart paper and post on wall.

2. Ask volunteers to break into four groups. Read the following scenario out loud. (This should also be written on chart paper and posted on wall.)

A major flood has hit the coastline in your country with 10,000 families losing their homes. About 500 people lost their lives. Survivors have moved to higher ground and are asking for help. It is raining every day. The National Society has 100 active volunteers who are involved in CBHFA and WASH programmes. The National Society is ready to act as first responders.

3. Recommend that groups discuss the scenario itself for a few minutes and talk about what the Red Cross Red Crescent team should think about before they respond to the crisis. Then, allocate one of the following questions to each group for discussion:

- What information should you get before you go?
- What are the benefits when a volunteer has access to the community?
- What information can a volunteer get when they have access to the health system?
- How will teams be formed? As a member of a team, what can you do to help the team be successful?

4. After five to seven minutes, return to a whole group session. Ask one volunteer from each group to summarize their group's question and response.

Response to Question (i) might include:

- names of communities involved
- number of people involved
- number of children under the age of five
- are there any other particularly vulnerable people
- is the community infrastructure completely destroyed or badly damaged
- are there injured or sick people?
- are they able to access local health clinics?
- can they access safe water?
- do they have access to safe sanitation?
- have livelihoods been destroyed?

Response to Question (ii) might include:

- local knowledge of community and culture
- knowledge of local health behaviours

- knowledge of local programmes
- language
- structure in community
- needs of the community

Response to Question (iii) might include:

- what are the current sicknesses (top five)
- any plans the health system may have to help e.g. a vaccination campaign
- are there any outbreaks of disease or rapid growth in numbers normally seen?
- knowledge of key messages to promote health and prevent disease

Response to Question 4 might include:

- supervisor at Red Cross Red Crescent knows capacities of volunteers and their backgrounds so can bring together people who will work effectively as part of the team
- team members bring different skills e.g. first aid, communication, health messaging
- eCBHFA programme knowledge

5. Respond to responses and clarify as appropriate. Give prompts so that the above are all covered.

Reflection

1. What is the primary focus of National Society teams in an emergency?
2. What is the primary role of eCBHFA volunteers within the health team?

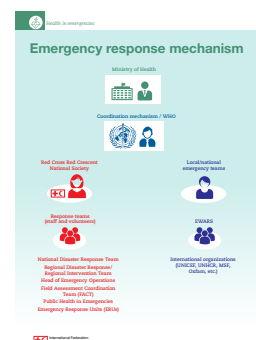
Role of Red Cross Red Crescent health teams reflection questions

1. Do you feel comfortable teaching this content to members of your community?
2. What content might be difficult for you to teach?

National and international response teams

□ Emergency response mechanism poster

1. Hand out the Emergency Response mechanism poster, showing the overall structure of the response, with the Ministry of Health at the top coordinating the effort. Review the IFRC response tools that can be requested during a post-disaster response. Ask for questions and respond as appropriate.
2. Based on the following emergencies ask volunteers which IFRC global tools they would consider using in the following scenarios. (These scenarios should be written on chart paper.) Help the group come to a consensus for each scenario. The first scenario should be done by the whole group. Second



and third scenarios may be done in the whole group or with partners.

- An earthquake occurs and results in over 1,000,000 people affected, major damage to existing buildings including hospitals. (Likely to ask for response teams at national, regional and international level including ERU field hospital, PSS, WASH teams, shelter, relief etc.)
 - Flooding affects 20,000 people on an island, water source contaminated, some minor damage to the hospital, varying damage to people's homes. (Most likely NDRT and RDRT, but depending on disaster effect may ask for a specific ERU e.g. small WASH team)
 - A disease outbreak affects over 100,000 people, hospitals and primary health care facilities overwhelmed; probable source identified as the major river. (Most likely, RDRT, FACT and PHiE initially, may ask for ERU specific for the disease outbreak e.g. cholera treatment centre and WASH teams.)
3. Remind volunteers that the Ministry of Health (MoH) has the overall responsibility for coordinating any disaster response in their country. One tool the MoH will use is the country's early warning and response system (EWARS). Review the use of EWARS.
 4. Ask volunteers to turn to a partner and discuss how a Red Cross Red Crescent team can contribute to the EWARS information and thereby help prevent a disease outbreak? Give volunteers two to three minutes to discuss. Then, return to plenary session and ask for volunteers to share their responses. Clarify responses and answer questions as appropriate.

Reflection

1. Who has the overall responsibility and lead in the health response of an emergency?
2. What are the six IFRC response teams? What is the purpose of each team?
3. Who is responsible for the early warning and response system (EWARS) or public health surveillance in their country?

National and international response teams reflection questions

1. Do you feel comfortable discussing what the Red Cross Red Crescent role in an emergency is and why we need to collect information when there is a disease outbreak (EWARS) to volunteers in your community?
2. What might be difficult for you to explain?

Local emergency teams

1. Review the types of emergency teams that may be participating in a post-disaster response. Ask for questions and clarify misconceptions.

Reflection

1. What national or local emergency teams might you encounter during an emergency in your role as a Red Cross Red Crescent volunteer?
2. What roles might a Red Cross Red Crescent volunteer play when working with other national or local teams?

Wrap-up

1. Review the learning objectives on the flipchart and ask the volunteers if they feel they have achieved each one.
2. As this is the last topic in the module, ask volunteers if they now feel prepared to respond to a disaster or emergency in their community, and also to teach about eCBHFA response to community members. Remind them that one reason to teach the content of the four topics is so that the community will understand what they are doing and will give them support in the event of having to respond to an emergency or disaster.
3. Ask volunteers about any lingering questions or concerns. Revisit topics and reinforce the learning if necessary.

The fundamental principles of the international Red Cross and Red Crescent movement

Humanity The international Red Cross and Red Crescent movement, born of a desire to bring assistance without discrimination to the wounded on the battlefield, endeavours, in its international and national capacity, to prevent and alleviate human suffering wherever it may be found. Its purpose is to protect life and health and to ensure respect for the human being. It promotes mutual understanding, friendship, cooperation and lasting peace amongst all peoples.

Impartiality It makes no discrimination as to nationality, race, religious beliefs, class or political opinions. It endeavours to relieve the suffering of individuals, being guided solely by their needs, and to give priority to the most urgent cases of distress.

Neutrality In order to enjoy the confidence of all, the Movement may not take sides in hostilities or engage at any time in controversies of a political, racial, religious or ideological nature.

Independence The movement is independent. The National Societies, while auxiliaries in the humanitarian services of their governments and subject to the laws of their respective countries, must always maintain their autonomy so that they may be able at all times to act in accordance with the principles of the Movement.

Voluntary service It is a voluntary relief movement not prompted in any manner by desire for gain.

Unity There can be only one Red Cross or Red Crescent Society in any one country. It must be open to all. It must carry on its humanitarian work throughout its territory.

Universality The international Red Cross and Red Crescent movement, in which all societies have equal status and share equal responsibilities and duties in helping each other, is worldwide.

For more information on this IFRC publication, please contact:

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